

VYNLITH



ADHD AI Prompt Pack

105 PROMPTS · 7 CATEGORIES

Built for how your brain actually works

By Vynlith

Practical tools for ADHD minds

Each prompt includes When to use this and Why it works, written in real ADHD community language. No generic productivity advice. Every prompt is built for a specific moment your ADHD brain will recognise.

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About This Pack

You bought this because generic productivity advice doesn't work for you. "Just make a to-do list" misses the whole point. "Set a timer" doesn't solve why you can't start. "Break it into smaller steps" falls apart when you can't figure out which step is actually first.

These 105 prompts are different. Each one is designed for a specific moment that ADHD brains actually experience - the paralysis before starting, the spiral when something goes wrong, the time blindness that makes a 30-minute task suddenly eat your whole afternoon. They work with your brain, not against it.

How to use this pack

Copy any prompt into ChatGPT, Claude, or your AI tool of choice. Replace anything in [brackets] with your actual situation. You don't need to use them in order - jump to whichever section matches where you are right now.

The "When to use this" notes tell you the exact moment each prompt is built for. The "Why it works" notes explain what's happening in your brain and why this approach helps. You don't need to read those sections - but if you've ever wondered why certain things work or not, they're there.

What's inside

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SECTION 1

Task Initiation

When your brain knows what needs doing but won't let you start

PROMPT 001

The First Tiny Step

PROMPT

I need to [task] but I can't start. Don't give me a full plan. Just tell me the single smallest possible action I could take right now - something that takes 2 minutes or less and doesn't require any decisions.

WHEN TO USE THIS

You're staring at the task, you understand it, but your hands won't move. This is task paralysis - different from procrastination. You're not avoiding it; your brain is stuck at the starting gate.

WHY IT WORKS

ADHD brains have trouble activating on tasks that feel large or ambiguous. Removing all decision-making from the first step lowers the activation energy enough that your brain can actually begin. Once you start, momentum usually carries you forward.

PROMPT 002

The Fake Deadline

PROMPT

Pretend you're my accountability partner. I need to [task] done by [real deadline]. Create an artificial deadline 48 hours earlier with a reason that would feel genuinely urgent to me, and write it like you're texting me as a friend, not emailing me as a manager.

WHEN TO USE THIS

You have a real deadline but your brain isn't treating it as real yet. You work better under pressure, but the pressure hasn't kicked in.

WHY IT WORKS

ADHD brains run on urgency and novelty. A deadline that feels abstract or far away doesn't activate the same circuits as one that feels immediate. A fake-but-believable earlier deadline tricks your brain into urgency mode sooner.

PROMPT 003

The Interest Bridge

PROMPT

I have to [boring/aversive task]. Find me 3 ways to make it more interesting or novel - not easier, just more interesting. I have [time limit] and [any constraints]. Be creative.

WHEN TO USE THIS

The task is genuinely boring and you keep bouncing off it. You're not stuck on difficulty - you're stuck on zero interest.

WHY IT WORKS

ADHD brains are wired for interest-based motivation. If something isn't interesting, urgent, challenging, or personally meaningful, it's hard to start regardless of importance. Adding a novelty layer - a game, a constraint, a weird approach - can make the same task suddenly doable.

PROMPT 004

The Permission Slip

PROMPT

I feel guilty for not starting [task] yet, and that guilt is making it harder to start. Talk to me like a kind friend who gets ADHD. Tell me why this makes sense, and then help me start without the guilt spiral.

WHEN TO USE THIS

You've been putting something off, you know you should have started earlier, and now the shame about not starting is adding a second layer of paralysis on top of the original paralysis.

WHY IT WORKS

ADHD often comes with rejection sensitivity and a harsh inner critic. Shame actually depletes the executive function resources you need to start. Breaking the shame loop first frees up cognitive resources to act.

PROMPT 005

The Body Double Script

PROMPT

Act as a virtual body double for the next [time]. Narrate working alongside me in real time. Say things like "okay, starting now," "still here," "you're doing fine," every few minutes. Don't give advice. Just be present.

WHEN TO USE THIS

You work better when someone else is in the room, even if they're not helping. You need the feeling of coworking without an actual human.

WHY IT WORKS

Body doubling is one of the most ADHD-specific strategies that genuinely works. External presence - even simulated - activates a different attention regulation mechanism. Having someone 'there' creates a subtle accountability loop that helps sustained focus.

PROMPT 006

The Chaos Dump

PROMPT

I can't start because there's too much in my head. Let me brain dump everything at you with no filter for 2 minutes [paste your thoughts]. Now sort it. What actually needs to happen today vs. what's anxiety noise?

WHEN TO USE THIS

Your brain is full of competing thoughts, tasks, worries, and half-plans and none of it will quiet down enough to let you pick one thing.

WHY IT WORKS

Working memory in ADHD brains is often overtaxed. When it's overloaded, the system locks up. Externalizing everything onto the page offloads that cognitive burden and lets you see the actual landscape instead of experiencing it as noise.

PROMPT 007**The Villain Reframe****PROMPT**

[Task I'm avoiding]. Reframe this as a quest where not completing it has real consequences for something I actually care about. Make the stakes feel real without catastrophizing. I care about [thing that matters to me].

WHEN TO USE THIS

The task feels pointless or disconnected from anything that matters to you, which is why you can't get traction on it.

WHY IT WORKS

ADHD brains need tasks to feel meaningful, not just important. Connecting a task to something you genuinely care about activates different motivation pathways. Stakes that feel personal and real work better than abstract consequences.

PROMPT 008**The 5-Minute Deal****PROMPT**

Make a deal with me. I'll work on [task] for exactly 5 minutes. At the end of 5 minutes, I'm allowed to stop with no guilt. Help me commit to just the 5 minutes. Write it as a contract I can screenshot.

WHEN TO USE THIS

You're convinced this task will take forever, and that belief is stopping you from starting. You need to reduce the perceived commitment.

WHY IT WORKS

The "just 5 minutes" approach works because ADHD brains misjudge time investment. The permission to stop after 5 minutes removes the threat of an open-ended commitment. Most of the time, starting is the hardest part - once started, you often continue past the 5 minutes.

PROMPT 009**The Inverse Planning****PROMPT**

I need to [task]. Don't tell me where to start. Tell me where to end. Describe what done looks like in specific, visual terms. Then work backwards to tell me the last 3 things I need to do before done.

WHEN TO USE THIS

You're overwhelmed by the front end of a task and can't see where to enter. Working backwards sometimes reveals a clearer path.

WHY IT WORKS

ADHD brains often struggle with prospective thinking (imagining future states). Anchoring to a concrete end state and working backwards uses a different cognitive pathway that can bypass the initiation block.

PROMPT 010**The Not-To-Do List****PROMPT**

I have [X hours] to work on [project]. Help me make a not-to-do list - all the things I would typically get distracted by or mistake for productive work. Make it specific to this project.

WHEN TO USE THIS

You start working but keep ending up doing the wrong things - organizing files instead of writing, researching instead of deciding, cleaning instead of creating.

WHY IT WORKS

ADHD brains often engage in "productive procrastination" - tasks that feel like work but avoid the actual hard thing. Making the avoidance behaviors explicit and specific helps you catch yourself in the moment.

PROMPT 011**The Energy Match****PROMPT**

My energy right now is [low/medium/scattered/anxious/hyperactive]. What's the best possible version of [task] I can do at this energy level? What parts should I skip until my energy is better?

WHEN TO USE THIS

You have to work on something but you know your current state isn't right for it. You need to work with your energy, not against it.

WHY IT WORKS

ADHD energy states are variable and harder to regulate than neurotypical ones. Matching task complexity to current state is a harm-reduction strategy - getting partial progress on the right parts beats zero progress from forcing the hardest parts.

PROMPT 012**The Context Rebuild****PROMPT**

I need to get back into [project/task] after being away from it for [time]. Help me rebuild the context. Here's what I remember: [brain dump]. Fill in what I might be forgetting and help me figure out where to pick back up.

WHEN TO USE THIS

You stopped working on something and now you can't remember where you were or how to re-enter. The activation cost of context-switching is too high.

WHY IT WORKS

Context switching is expensive for everyone, but especially for ADHD brains. The working memory overhead of rebuilding context can feel overwhelming enough to avoid re-entry entirely. Externalizing the rebuild process makes it far lower cost.

PROMPT 013**The Objection Clearer****PROMPT**

I need to [task] but I keep not doing it. Ask me 5 questions to help figure out what's actually blocking me - is it unclear what "done" means? Is it aversive? Is it scary? I don't know yet. Help me figure out which kind of stuck this is.

WHEN TO USE THIS

You've tried to start multiple times and failed. You don't actually know why you can't start.

WHY IT WORKS

There are different kinds of "stuck" - task paralysis, avoidance, fear, confusion, overwhelm - and they need different solutions. Diagnosing which one you're dealing with before trying to solve it is far more effective than generic productivity advice.

PROMPT 014**The Hyperfocus Hijack****PROMPT**

I tend to hyperfocus on [interesting thing] instead of working on [necessary thing]. Help me use my hyperfocus on [interesting thing] to make progress on [necessary thing]. Find a real connection or overlap between them.

WHEN TO USE THIS

You're hyperfocusing on something interesting and can't redirect yourself, but you also know there's real work you need to do.

WHY IT WORKS

Fighting hyperfocus usually fails. Finding legitimate overlap between the hyperfocus target and the necessary work lets you channel existing energy rather than trying to generate new energy from scratch.

PROMPT 015**The Tomorrow-Me Letter****PROMPT**

Write a letter from tomorrow-me to today-me, describing how good it felt to finish [task] tonight. Make it specific - what time I finished, how I felt, what I did with the rest of the evening. Make tomorrow-me sound happy.

WHEN TO USE THIS

You're not starting because the future reward doesn't feel real. You need to make the positive outcome more visceral.

WHY IT WORKS

ADHD brains have difficulty with temporal discounting - future rewards feel less motivating than immediate ones. Making the future state vivid and specific (not abstract) can bring it closer psychologically and increase present motivation.

SECTION 2

Focus and Flow Management

When you need to enter deep work and stay there

PROMPT 016

The Focus Container

PROMPT

Help me set up a "focus container" for the next [time]. Tell me: what to put away, what to close on my screen, what to have in front of me, and what to tell myself when I start to drift. Make it a simple ritual I can do in under 3 minutes.

WHEN TO USE THIS

You're about to do focused work but your environment and mental state aren't set up for it. You need a quick transition ritual.

WHY IT WORKS

ADHD brains benefit from environmental scaffolding. Physical setup signals to your brain that it's time to focus. A consistent pre-focus ritual builds a conditioned response over time - the setup itself starts to trigger focus mode.

PROMPT 017

The Focus Refresher

PROMPT

I've been working on [task] for [time] and I feel my focus starting to go. I have [time] left to work. Help me reset - what should I do for exactly 5 minutes to come back stronger? No screens.

WHEN TO USE THIS

You can feel your attention slipping but you're not done yet. You need a short reset that actually works, not a break that turns into a 45-minute scroll.

WHY IT WORKS

Strategic micro-breaks can restore attention, but only if they're the right kind. Screen breaks often don't restore focus and can trigger hyperfocus on something else. Physical movement or sensory resets tend to be most effective for ADHD brains.

PROMPT 018

The Hyperfocus Window

PROMPT

I'm in hyperfocus on [task] right now. Help me make the most of this window. What's the highest-value thing I can do in the next hour while I'm in this state? And set me a trigger - what should I do when I notice the hyperfocus ending?

WHEN TO USE THIS

You've entered a hyperfocus state on something useful. You want to maximize it and also have a planned exit so you don't crash.

WHY IT WORKS

Hyperfocus is ADHD's superpower when it lands on the right target. Having a plan for what to accomplish during the window means you capture more value. Planning the exit in advance prevents the post-hyperfocus crash from leading to uncontrolled shutdown.

PROMPT 019**The Distraction Parking Lot****PROMPT**

I keep thinking of things mid-task. Act as my distraction parking lot. I'll tell you each thought as it appears. Just reply "parked" and number it. At the end of my session, give me the full list so I can deal with them.

WHEN TO USE THIS

Your brain keeps generating interrupting thoughts while you're trying to work - ideas, things you've forgotten, random concerns.

WHY IT WORKS

Trying to suppress intrusive thoughts takes mental energy and often fails. Externalizing them quickly satisfies the brain's need to "not forget it" without requiring you to act on them now. The thought is captured; you can let it go.

PROMPT 020**The Re-Entry Script****PROMPT**

I got pulled out of my focus by [interruption]. I was working on [task] and I was at [specific point]. Help me write a re-entry script - what I say to myself, what I look at first, and what I do first to get back in.

WHEN TO USE THIS

Something external broke your focus and now you can't get back in. The context reconstruction feels too hard.

WHY IT WORKS

Re-entry after interruption is a specific weakness for ADHD. Having a scripted process removes the cognitive overhead of figuring out how to re-enter, which is often the real barrier to resuming.

PROMPT 021**The Focus Forecast****PROMPT**

It's [time] and I have until [time]. Map out my likely focus windows today based on what I know about ADHD energy patterns. Tell me what to do in each window: deep work, admin, communication, rest. Be specific.

WHEN TO USE THIS

You have a full day and want to schedule work to match your actual energy patterns rather than fighting them.

WHY IT WORKS

ADHD energy is typically non-linear. Scheduling demanding tasks when your brain chemistry is most cooperative (usually mid-morning for most people) and lighter tasks when energy dips leads to far better output than forcing deep work at the wrong time.

PROMPT 022

The Single Thread

PROMPT

I'm working on [project] but I keep jumping between different parts. Help me pick one thread to follow until it's finished. Here's what's open: [list]. Which one should I complete first and why?

WHEN TO USE THIS

You have multiple parts of a project open simultaneously and keep switching between them without finishing any.

WHY IT WORKS

Task-switching is particularly costly for ADHD brains because each switch requires a full context rebuild. Completing one thread fully before opening another is cognitively cheaper, even if it feels less efficient in the moment.

PROMPT 023

The Novelty Injection

PROMPT

I've been doing [task] for too long and I'm losing focus because it's gotten repetitive. Add novelty without changing what I'm doing. Give me a different angle, a constraint, a game, or a reframing that makes it feel new.

WHEN TO USE THIS

You've hit the point where the task has become boring enough that focus is collapsing. You're not done, but the interest has evaporated.

WHY IT WORKS

ADHD brains are novelty-seeking. When novelty drops below a threshold, the reward system disengages. Artificially re-introducing novelty - even through a small change in approach - can re-activate engagement.

PROMPT 024

The Focus Anchor

PROMPT

Give me a mantra or anchor phrase for when my focus starts to drift on [task]. It should be short, honest about ADHD, and pull me back without judgment. Something I could repeat 20 times today without it feeling hollow.

WHEN TO USE THIS

You notice you're drifting frequently and need a quick internal reset that doesn't require breaking flow.

WHY IT WORKS

Short, personally meaningful phrases can serve as attention anchors. The key is that they're non-judgmental - self-criticism when you drift actually makes refocus harder, not easier.

PROMPT 025**The Flow State Pre-Load****PROMPT**

I want to get into flow state for [task] in the next 20 minutes. Design a pre-load routine for me: what to listen to, what to read or watch for 5 minutes beforehand, and how to transition into the actual work. Match the mood to [type of work].

WHEN TO USE THIS

You have a focused work block coming up and you want to enter it already primed, not spend the first 20 minutes warming up.

WHY IT WORKS

Flow states can be deliberately primed by managing your arousal level, environment, and mental state in advance. Pre-loading with content that matches the cognitive demand of the task helps smooth the transition.

PROMPT 026**The Drift Detector****PROMPT**

I drift most often when [describe your usual drift pattern]. Build me a drift-detection checklist I can glance at every 15 minutes to catch myself before I'm fully gone.

WHEN TO USE THIS

You want to build self-awareness about your specific distraction patterns so you can catch them earlier.

WHY IT WORKS

Most ADHD drift is habitual and follows patterns. Naming your specific drift behaviors makes them more visible in the moment. Catching drift at step one is far easier than catching it after 40 minutes of spiraling.

PROMPT 027**The Pomodoro Negotiation****PROMPT**

I can't do 25-minute focus blocks right now - my brain won't sustain it. Negotiate a modified Pomodoro with me based on what I can actually sustain today, which feels like [X minutes]. Give me a full schedule of work/break cycles for the next [hours].

WHEN TO USE THIS

The standard 25-minute Pomodoro feels impossible, but you need some structure. You need a version that fits your actual capacity.

WHY IT WORKS

Time-boxing works for ADHD, but one-size schedules don't. On low-focus days, 10-minute blocks with 5-minute breaks can be more productive than failing at 25-minute blocks. Customizing the structure to your actual state is more effective than forcing a standard format.

PROMPT 028**The Silent Session****PROMPT**

Act as my silent coworker for the next [time]. Check in with me every [X minutes] with just: "[check-in number]: How's it going? What are you on?" I'll reply briefly. If I don't reply in 5 minutes, prompt me again. No advice unless I ask.

WHEN TO USE THIS

You need regular light touch-points to stay on track but don't want full accountability - just gentle presence.

WHY IT WORKS

Regular low-overhead check-ins mimic the social regulation that comes from coworking with others. The act of briefly reporting "what I'm on" is enough to keep most ADHD brains from fully drifting.

PROMPT 029**The Completion High****PROMPT**

I'm about to finish [task]. Talk me through the last part in a way that makes it feel exciting to complete, not just relieving. Build anticipation for the finish line.

WHEN TO USE THIS

You're close to done but losing steam right at the end. The finish line is visible but you're slowing down.

WHY IT WORKS

ADHD brains often lose motivation near the end of tasks because the novelty has worn off and the future reward doesn't feel close enough. Re-framing the end as an active goal rather than a relief can restore drive.

PROMPT 030**The Recovery Protocol****PROMPT**

I completely lost my focus and spiraled for [time]. I feel [emotion]. I have [time] left in my day. I'm not going to pretend the lost time didn't happen. Help me triage what to do with the remaining time, starting from right now.

WHEN TO USE THIS

You've had a significant focus failure and you're in the shame/frustration aftermath. You need to recover without pretending it didn't happen.

WHY IT WORKS

Pretending a spiral didn't happen doesn't help. Acknowledging the loss and making a realistic plan for remaining time is more productive than either catastrophizing or toxic positivity. Triage beats guilt.

SECTION 3

Time Blindness

When time doesn't feel real until it's gone

PROMPT 031

The Time Reality Check

PROMPT

I think [task] will take [my estimate]. Challenge my estimate. Ask me what I'm not accounting for. Based on what I tell you, give me a realistic time range and tell me when I should actually start to finish by [deadline].

WHEN TO USE THIS

You know your time estimates are usually wrong but you can't see where the gaps are. You need an external calibration.

WHY IT WORKS

ADHD brains notoriously underestimate task duration - this is time blindness in action. An external calibration that asks "what are you not counting?" helps surface hidden time costs: transition time, decision time, error time, and admin that doesn't feel like "the task" but takes real minutes.

PROMPT 032

The Time Visualizer

PROMPT

I have from [current time] to [deadline]. Visualize this for me as if time were physical space. Describe what [time remaining] looks like in terms I can feel, not just calculate. Then tell me how much space [task] actually takes up in that space.

WHEN TO USE THIS

You know the numbers but they don't feel real. You need a spatial or sensory way to understand the time remaining.

WHY IT WORKS

ADHD time blindness is partly a failure of temporal visceral awareness - time as a concept doesn't feel real the way it does for neurotypical people. Spatial metaphors can bridge this gap, converting an abstract countdown into something that feels more present.

PROMPT 033

The Task Autopsy

PROMPT

[Task] took [actual time] but I thought it would take [my estimate]. Do a quick autopsy. Ask me 3 questions about what happened. Then help me build a correction factor I can apply to future estimates for similar tasks.

WHEN TO USE THIS

After a task took much longer than expected. You want to learn from it, not just move on.

WHY IT WORKS

Building a personal correction factor ("my writing estimates are always 2.5x too short") is more useful than generic advice. Task autopsies done immediately after, while memory is fresh, build real calibration data over time.

PROMPT 034**The Transition Timer****PROMPT**

I need to switch from [current activity] to [next activity] in [time]. Build me a transition routine that takes exactly [X minutes] and actually gets me there. Account for the fact that I don't want to stop [current activity].

WHEN TO USE THIS

You know you need to switch activities but you're resisting and the transition is going to be messy.

WHY IT WORKS

Transitions are high-risk moments for ADHD. Unmanaged transitions often lead to either avoidance of the next task or staying stuck in the current one past deadline. A timed, explicit transition routine reduces the friction of the shift.

PROMPT 035**The Deadline Countdown****PROMPT**

My deadline for [task] is [date/time]. Work backwards and create a countdown timeline. For each day between now and then, tell me what "on track" looks like. Make it specific enough that I can check in with myself daily.

WHEN TO USE THIS

You have a meaningful deadline and want to build in daily checkpoints rather than waking up the day before.

WHY IT WORKS

ADHD planning often fails because the gap between "now" and "deadline" isn't broken into observable checkpoints. When you can ask "am I on track right now?" the future feels present and manageable.

PROMPT 036**The Time Trap List****PROMPT**

I often lose track of time when [list your common time traps]. For each one, help me build a 30-second intervention I can do the moment I notice I've fallen into it.

WHEN TO USE THIS

You have predictable time sinks that you fall into repeatedly. You want specific, fast exits from each one.

WHY IT WORKS

Generic advice to "avoid distractions" doesn't work. Specific interventions for specific traps do. The 30-second frame matters because long interventions require willpower; short ones can be automatic.

PROMPT 037**The Soft Stop****PROMPT**

I need to stop working at [time] but I never actually stop. Help me build a "soft stop" protocol for today. Something that ramps down instead of just cutting off. I tend to ignore hard stops.

WHEN TO USE THIS

You work past your intended stop time, which then throws off sleep, meals, or evening commitments.

WHY IT WORKS

ADHD brains don't respond well to arbitrary hard stops. A wind-down protocol - decreasing task intensity over 20 minutes - respects how the attention system actually disengages and reduces the likelihood of just ignoring the end time.

PROMPT 038**The Now vs. Not Now Sort****PROMPT**

Here's my task list: [list]. Sort this into "must happen today" vs. "actually can wait" - not what I feel is urgent, but what is actually urgent based on external consequences. Challenge me if I'm over-claiming urgency.

WHEN TO USE THIS

Everything feels urgent and you can't prioritize because your urgency detector is miscalibrated.

WHY IT WORKS

ADHD often comes with a flattened urgency hierarchy - nothing feels urgent until it's on fire, or everything feels equally urgent. External sorting by actual consequence rather than felt urgency helps break through this.

PROMPT 039**The Time Audit****PROMPT**

I feel like I'm always running out of time but I don't know where it goes. Help me run a quick 10-minute time audit for today. Ask me what I actually did in each hour since [start time]. Then tell me what patterns you see.

WHEN TO USE THIS

You feel perpetually time-poor but can't see why. You need an honest accounting.

WHY IT WORKS

ADHD brains often have poor retrospective time awareness. A prompted hour-by-hour audit surfaces activities that didn't feel like time but were (transitions, social media, decision loops). Seeing the pattern is the first step to changing it.

PROMPT 040**The Time Buffer Builder****PROMPT**

I have [task] and [task] and [task] to do before [deadline]. Add buffers. I tend to think I can run tasks back-to-back with no gap. Tell me what's realistic with transition time, fatigue time, and at least one "it went wrong" contingency built in.

WHEN TO USE THIS

You're planning a day and it looks like everything fits perfectly on paper. It never actually fits.

WHY IT WORKS

ADHD scheduling often fails because it's optimistic planning with no margin. Buffer time isn't wasted time - it's error tolerance. A plan with 30% buffer has far higher completion rates than a plan that requires everything to go perfectly.

PROMPT 041**The Urgency Reality Test****PROMPT**

I feel like I urgently need to [task] right now. But I'm in the middle of [other task]. Is this real urgency or ADHD urgency? Ask me 3 questions to help me figure out which one this is, then help me decide.

WHEN TO USE THIS

A new thing has appeared that feels urgent and is threatening to derail what you were already doing.

WHY IT WORKS

ADHD brains create false urgency signals - new and interesting tasks feel urgent because they're activating. Distinguishing between real consequences-based urgency and novelty-driven urgency is a skill that can be built with the right prompts.

PROMPT 042**The Recurring Time Fail****PROMPT**

Every [day/week] I fail to [thing I always fail to do in time]. I've tried [solutions I've tried]. Help me diagnose why those solutions failed and design a different approach that accounts for the fact that I have ADHD.

WHEN TO USE THIS

You have a chronic time management failure you haven't been able to fix. You've tried the obvious stuff.

WHY IT WORKS

Generic time management solutions often don't work for ADHD because they assume consistent executive function. Understanding why a specific strategy failed (was it the trigger? the timing? the friction?) helps design one that accounts for your actual constraints.

PROMPT 043**The Estimate Log****PROMPT**

For the next week, I'll tell you one task per day and my time estimate. At the end of the week, I'll report back actual times. Track these for me and at the end of 5 days, tell me my average error rate and pattern.

WHEN TO USE THIS

You want to build real data on your estimation errors over time, not just guess at your bias.

WHY IT WORKS

Systematic logging of estimates vs. actuals is one of the most effective ways to reduce time blindness. Seeing a pattern ("I underestimate creative work by 3x but nail admin tasks") gives you data to apply in future planning.

PROMPT 044**The Pre-Mortem****PROMPT**

I'm planning [task or day]. Assume it goes wrong. What are the 3 most likely ways I'll lose time? For each one, give me a specific prevention or recovery plan.

WHEN TO USE THIS

You're setting up a work session or day and want to plan for your known failure modes rather than being blindsided.

WHY IT WORKS

Pre-mortems force you to plan for likely risks rather than assuming everything will go smoothly. For ADHD, naming specific failure modes ("rabbit hole research," "task-switch spiral") and having exits planned reduces their impact.

PROMPT 045**The Time-OK Moment****PROMPT**

I just wasted [time] and I feel terrible about it. Help me calculate what is still genuinely possible today given the time I have left, without toxic positivity. What can I realistically finish? What should I explicitly let go of?

WHEN TO USE THIS

You've lost time to distraction or a spiral and you need an honest reset, not fake reassurance.

WHY IT WORKS

The shame after wasted time can extend the wasted time. A realistic assessment of what's still possible - with permission to let some things go - allows productive action to resume. Triage is a skill; not triaging costs more time.

SECTION 4

Executive Function Support

When planning, organizing, and deciding feel impossible

PROMPT 046

The Project Brain Dump

PROMPT

I need to plan [project] but planning feels impossible. Let me brain dump everything about it with no structure: [dump]. Now you organize it. Tell me what phases exist, what's blocking what, and what the first actionable task is.

WHEN TO USE THIS

You have a project that needs planning but every time you try to make a plan, you freeze.

WHY IT WORKS

Creating structure from scratch is high executive function load. Separating the "dump everything" step from the "organize it" step removes the working memory burden of holding the whole project while also trying to sort it. AI does the organizing; you supply the raw material.

PROMPT 047

The Decision Tiebreaker

PROMPT

I need to decide between [option A] and [option B]. I've been going back and forth for [time]. I'm not asking you to decide for me. Ask me 3 questions that will help me figure out which matters more to me, then summarize what my answers revealed.

WHEN TO USE THIS

You're caught in a decision loop. You've been thinking about the same choice for too long and can't close it.

WHY IT WORKS

ADHD decision paralysis often isn't about the decision itself but about anxiety around making the wrong choice. Questions that clarify values cut through the anxiety by focusing on what actually matters. Reflecting your own answers back to you often reveals a preference you already had.

PROMPT 048

The Task Sizer

PROMPT

I have [big task]. Break it down. But stop when each piece takes no more than [X minutes] to complete. If a piece is still too big, break it down again. Keep going until every item is genuinely doable in one sitting.

WHEN TO USE THIS

A task breakdown exists but the pieces are still too large to feel actionable.

WHY IT WORKS

"Break it into smaller steps" is common advice, but it often stops too early. For ADHD brains, each step needs to be small enough to be startable with minimal activation energy. True task breakdown goes further than most people think.

PROMPT 049

The Priority Stack

PROMPT

Here's everything I need to do this week: [list]. Stack-rank it. Not by urgency, not by importance - by what order I should do them in considering dependencies, my energy patterns, and what will unblock other things. Explain your reasoning.

WHEN TO USE THIS

You have a pile of tasks and no clear order. You're spending mental energy on prioritization that should be spent on execution.

WHY IT WORKS

A dependency-aware priority stack is more efficient than urgency-based ordering. Doing things that unblock other things first multiplies your output. Having the stack pre-decided also removes the repeated decision cost of "what should I do next."

PROMPT 050

The Memory Offload

PROMPT

I need to remember [list of things]. Design a memory offload system for this specific list using only tools I already have: [tools I have]. Make it simple enough that I'll actually use it when I'm rushed or distracted.

WHEN TO USE THIS

You need to remember multiple things and you're worried you'll forget them without a system - but you also know complex systems fail for you.

WHY IT WORKS

ADHD working memory is unreliable. Offloading to external systems works, but only if the system is frictionless enough to actually use. Designing the simplest possible capture system for your specific situation reduces the gap between intention and use.

PROMPT 051

The Stuck Point Diagnosis

PROMPT

I've been stuck on [task] for [time]. I'm not procrastinating - I genuinely don't know how to proceed. Here's where I am: [describe current state]. Ask me questions until we figure out what's actually blocking me.

WHEN TO USE THIS

You're genuinely blocked, not avoiding. The path forward isn't clear and you need to think it through with help.

WHY IT WORKS

Stuck points often have specific causes: missing information, unclear scope, a decision that needs to be made, or a dependency on someone else. Diagnosing the exact cause before trying to solve it leads to faster unblocking.

PROMPT 052**The Meeting Prep****PROMPT**

I have a meeting about [topic] in [time]. I'm unprepared. Give me the minimum viable prep - what I actually need to know, what I should have ready to say, and one question I should ask. 5 minutes of prep, no more.

WHEN TO USE THIS

A meeting is approaching and you haven't prepared. You need the minimum effective preparation, not a deep dive.

WHY IT WORKS

ADHD meeting prep often fails because the "do it properly" framing makes it feel too large to start. Minimum viable prep - specific, bounded, and immediately actionable - is better than no prep.

PROMPT 053**The Email Untangle****PROMPT**

Here's an email I need to respond to: [paste email]. I've been avoiding it because [reason]. Write me 3 possible responses: the safe option, the honest option, and the direct option. I'll pick or combine.

WHEN TO USE THIS

An email has been sitting in your inbox for too long. The act of avoiding it is taking more mental energy than responding would.

WHY IT WORKS

Email avoidance is extremely common in ADHD and often involves decision paralysis and anxiety. Having multiple response options removes the blank-page problem and lets you pick the approach that fits your current energy.

PROMPT 054**The Scope Limiter****PROMPT**

I'm working on [project/task] and it's ballooning. I keep adding things to it. Help me define the hard boundary of what this project actually is and isn't. What should I cut to ship what matters?

WHEN TO USE THIS

A task or project keeps growing because every time you work on it you see more that could be done.

WHY IT WORKS

ADHD hyperfocus often generates scope creep - you see connections and improvements everywhere. Having a clearly defined scope boundary with explicit "out of scope" lists helps resist the pull of expansion and actually reach completion.

PROMPT 055

The System Setup

PROMPT

I need a system to manage [recurring task/area of life]. My past attempts at systems failed because [reasons]. Design one that has fewer than 4 steps, requires almost no willpower, and is almost impossible to abandon accidentally.

WHEN TO USE THIS

You need a routine or system but your previous attempts have all eventually collapsed.

WHY IT WORKS

Systems fail for ADHD when they require high willpower, many steps, or external memory. An effective ADHD system is boring and simple - it runs on triggers and environment design, not intention and discipline.

PROMPT 056

The Next Action Rule

PROMPT

I have a project called [project]. Apply the Getting Things Done "next action" rule to it strictly. What is the single next physical action that moves this forward? Not a phase, not a plan, but an actual verb-first action I can start in the next 10 minutes.

WHEN TO USE THIS

A project exists on your list but never moves because the next step isn't specific enough to start.

WHY IT WORKS

"Work on proposal" is not an action. "Open the document and write the executive summary first paragraph" is an action. The specificity gap between these two is often the reason things stall. Verb-first, specific, immediate actions are the minimum unit of productivity.

PROMPT 057

The Forgotten Task Recovery

PROMPT

I suddenly remembered I was supposed to [task] and it's now [overdue/nearly due]. I feel panicked. Help me: 1) figure out if this is as bad as it feels, 2) decide what to do first, and 3) communicate with anyone who needs to know.

WHEN TO USE THIS

You've forgotten something important and you're in panic mode. You need clear thinking when you're least capable of it.

WHY IT WORKS

Panic degrades executive function exactly when you need it most. A structured 3-part response (assess, act, communicate) gives your brain a scaffold to run on when it's overwhelmed.

PROMPT 058

The Admin Sprint

PROMPT

I have a pile of admin tasks I've been avoiding: [list]. Design me a 30-minute admin sprint. Batch similar things, set a sequence, and give me a "done" signal for each one. Make it feel like a game, not a chore.

WHEN TO USE THIS

Admin tasks have piled up and you need to clear them. You keep avoiding them because they're low-interest.

WHY IT WORKS

Admin tasks are low-interest but necessary. Batching them, time-boxing them, and adding gamification elements (sequence, completion signals) makes the session feel bounded and manageable rather than open-ended and draining.

PROMPT 059

The Option Reducer

PROMPT

I have [N] options for [decision]. I can't decide because too many options feel overwhelming. Reduce this to 2 options maximum using [criteria I care about]. Then help me flip a coin and commit.

WHEN TO USE THIS

You're stuck in a decision because there are too many valid-seeming options.

WHY IT WORKS

Decision fatigue hits ADHD brains fast. Reducing options to 2 with a clear criteria set, then committing to one, beats endless comparison. Sometimes "good enough" committed to is far better than "best possible" never decided on.

PROMPT 060

The Project Runway

PROMPT

Project [name] has been sitting untouched for [time]. Either I need to restart it or I need to officially kill it. Help me make that decision. Ask me 4 questions. Be honest - not everything deserves to be revived.

WHEN TO USE THIS

A project has been lingering in a zombie state. You haven't touched it but it's taking up mental space.

WHY IT WORKS

Zombie projects create cognitive load even when dormant. Making a deliberate kill-or-restart decision frees up mental space. Not everything deserves to be finished; finishing the decision is still finishing.

SECTION 5

Emotional Regulation

When feelings are getting in the way of function

PROMPT 061

The RSD Check-In

PROMPT

I just received [feedback/rejection/criticism] and I'm having a big reaction. I think it might be RSD. Talk me through it: help me separate what actually happened from what I'm adding. Don't minimize it, but help me see it more clearly.

WHEN TO USE THIS

You've received criticism or perceived rejection and your emotional response feels much bigger than the event warrants.

WHY IT WORKS

Rejection Sensitive Dysphoria (RSD) is extremely common in ADHD and involves intense emotional pain from perceived rejection or failure. Having a framework to separate "what happened" from "what I added" isn't about dismissing the pain - it's about finding the actual signal in the noise.

PROMPT 062

The Overwhelm Sorter

PROMPT

I am overwhelmed. Everything feels too much right now. Don't tell me to breathe. Don't tell me it will be okay. Just help me sort what I'm feeling: what's actually wrong versus what feels wrong because I'm overwhelmed. Start with questions.

WHEN TO USE THIS

You're in an overwhelm state and generic reassurance isn't helping. You need to actually sort through what's happening.

WHY IT WORKS

Overwhelm in ADHD often involves a mix of real problems and amplified-by-brain-state problems. During overwhelm, the amygdala is running hot and the prefrontal cortex is impaired. Sorting with external help offloads the cognitive demand of doing it alone.

PROMPT 063

The Frustration Outlet

PROMPT

I am very frustrated with [situation]. Before I try to fix anything, let me just vent at you. I'm going to say some things that aren't totally fair. Just listen and reflect back what you heard without judgment. Then I'll try to think clearly.

WHEN TO USE THIS

You're in a high-frustration state and you know you need to discharge it before you can think clearly.

WHY IT WORKS

Trying to problem-solve while emotionally dysregulated is inefficient and often makes things worse. Venting first discharges emotional pressure, which allows the prefrontal cortex to re-engage. This is emotional regulation, not avoidance.

PROMPT 064**The Failure Debrief****PROMPT**

I [failed at something]. Not catastrophically, but I'm having a hard time not spinning out. Help me do a clean debrief: what actually happened, what I contributed, what I didn't control, and one thing I'd do differently. No toxic positivity.

WHEN TO USE THIS

Something went wrong and you're stuck between minimizing it and catastrophizing it. You need a balanced accounting.

WHY IT WORKS

ADHD brains often struggle with balanced failure processing - either dismissing failures too quickly (and not learning) or spiraling into shame. A structured debrief helps build the skill of clean processing: acknowledging, analyzing, and moving forward.

PROMPT 065**The Shame Interruption****PROMPT**

I'm in a shame spiral about [thing]. I know it's not helping but I can't stop. Don't tell me I shouldn't feel this way. Help me interrupt the spiral with something useful to do right now, even if it's tiny.

WHEN TO USE THIS

You're actively spiraling and you know it. You need an exit that doesn't require you to just "feel better."

WHY IT WORKS

Shame spirals are neurologically real - they activate the threat response and impair executive function. The most effective interruption is behavioral action, not thought substitution. Doing literally anything small creates a pattern interrupt that gives you a foothold out.

PROMPT 066**The Fear Sort****PROMPT**

I'm avoiding [task] and I think it's fear, not laziness. Help me figure out what I'm actually afraid of. Ask me about: fear of failure, fear of success, fear of judgment, fear of it being imperfect. I'll tell you what resonates.

WHEN TO USE THIS

You're avoiding something and you suspect the avoidance is emotional, not motivational.

WHY IT WORKS

ADHD avoidance is often indistinguishable from emotional avoidance from the inside. Identifying the specific fear changes the intervention. Procrastination from perfectionism needs a different response than procrastination from boredom.

PROMPT 067**The Apology Draft****PROMPT**

I need to apologize to [person] for [thing I did/didn't do that was related to ADHD]. Help me write something honest that acknowledges what happened without over-explaining my ADHD or using it as an excuse. Short, genuine, no drama.

WHEN TO USE THIS

You've let someone down due to ADHD symptoms and you need to repair it without turning it into a lengthy explanation.

WHY IT WORKS

ADHD often involves impacts on others. Genuine repair is important for relationships and self-respect. An apology that acknowledges impact without excessive explanation is harder to write than it sounds.

PROMPT 068**The Comparison Detox****PROMPT**

I'm comparing myself to [neurotypical person/old version of me/imaginary version of me] and it's making me feel terrible. I know the comparison isn't fair but I can't stop it. Help me reframe without dismissing what I'm feeling.

WHEN TO USE THIS

You're in a comparison spiral that's eroding your motivation or self-worth.

WHY IT WORKS

Comparison is painful and counterproductive, especially for ADHD brains that have often internalized years of "why can't you just..." messages. A reframe that acknowledges the unfairness of the comparison is more useful than either toxic positivity or validation-only.

PROMPT 069**The Transition Grief****PROMPT**

I have to stop doing [thing I love/hyperfocus] to do [thing I have to do]. I know I'm being irrational but it feels like a real loss. Help me name what I'm actually losing and find a way to honor it briefly before moving on.

WHEN TO USE THIS

Transitioning away from something enjoyable feels genuinely painful and is making the transition harder than it needs to be.

WHY IT WORKS

ADHD hyperfocus exit is genuinely difficult and the resistance isn't irrational - stopping something that's meeting your brain's stimulation needs feels like deprivation. Naming the loss and acknowledging it briefly is more effective than fighting the feeling.

PROMPT 070**The Burnout Signal Read****PROMPT**

I've been feeling [symptoms - exhausted, irritable, can't start things, don't care]. Is this burnout, regular ADHD struggle, or something else? Help me distinguish. Ask me questions. I want to understand what's happening, not just cope with it.

WHEN TO USE THIS

Something feels different than usual and you're not sure what's going on. You need a clearer read on your current state before you can address it.

WHY IT WORKS

ADHD burnout is real and different from regular ADHD difficulty. Distinguishing between "this is hard because ADHD" and "this is hard because I've hit a wall" changes the response needed. Pushing through burnout usually makes it worse.

PROMPT 071**The Win Log****PROMPT**

I had a bad ADHD day. List-making feels overwhelming. Instead, just ask me to tell you one thing I did today that I can count as a win - no matter how small. Then tell me why that counts.

WHEN TO USE THIS

You've had a hard day and you need to end it on something real, not performative positivity.

WHY IT WORKS

ADHD brains tend to weigh failures heavily and undercount successes. Regular acknowledgment of small wins isn't naive optimism - it's calibration. Ending the day with one real acknowledgment protects against the cumulative shame that builds from only ever seeing what went wrong.

PROMPT 072**The Body Check-In****PROMPT**

I'm struggling to focus and I don't know why. Before we troubleshoot, run me through a quick physical check: hunger, hydration, sleep, movement, meds if applicable. Ask me each one. Then tell me which physical factor is most likely dragging my performance right now.

WHEN TO USE THIS

Your focus is worse than usual and you haven't considered that the cause might be physical, not cognitive.

WHY IT WORKS

ADHD executive function is highly sensitive to physical state - more so than neurotypical brains. Hunger, dehydration, and lack of movement have outsized effects on attention regulation. Checking physical causes first is often the fastest fix.

PROMPT 073**The Rejection Prep****PROMPT**

I have to [send something/apply for something/do something where I might be rejected]. I'm avoiding it because the possible rejection feels unbearable. Help me pre-process the rejection before it happens, so it doesn't feel like the end of the world.

WHEN TO USE THIS

Anticipatory RSD is stopping you from taking action. The fear of potential rejection is more immobilizing than actual rejection would be.

WHY IT WORKS

Pre-processing rejection - imagining it happening and surviving it - reduces the threat response before you take action. You can rehearse the "it didn't work out" scenario until it doesn't feel catastrophic, which lowers the emotional stakes enough to act.

PROMPT 074**The Mood Map****PROMPT**

My mood today has been [description]. Map this against what I know about ADHD mood patterns. Help me understand if what I'm feeling is brain-based, situation-based, or both. Not to fix it - just to understand it.

WHEN TO USE THIS

You're experiencing a mood that doesn't seem to connect clearly to your circumstances and you want to understand it better.

WHY IT WORKS

ADHD involves significant emotional dysregulation that is neurological, not character-based. Understanding that a low mood or irritability might be brain-based rather than a response to circumstances changes how you relate to it.

PROMPT 075**The Self-Compassion Script****PROMPT**

Write me a 5-sentence internal script I can say to myself when I'm in ADHD shame mode. Make it honest and non-patronizing. It should acknowledge the real difficulty while not catastrophizing. I will memorize this and use it.

WHEN TO USE THIS

You want a rehearsed script for shame moments that you can deploy automatically when your prefrontal cortex is offline.

WHY IT WORKS

Having a memorized script for high-shame moments is more reliable than trying to think your way through compassion when you're dysregulated. Pre-loading the response means it can deploy even when executive function is low.

SECTION 6

Body Doubling and Accountability

When you work better with someone alongside you

PROMPT 076

The Body Double Session Start

PROMPT

Let's body double for the next [time]. I'm working on [task]. I'll report in every [X minutes] with what I just did. You just say something like "nice, keep going" or "what's next?" Keep it brief. Start us off.

WHEN TO USE THIS

You need the presence of someone working alongside you and no real human is available.

WHY IT WORKS

Body doubling works for a majority of ADHD people. Having another presence - even an AI - can activate the social accountability mechanism in the brain. The brief check-ins create a low-overhead rhythm that keeps attention tethered without feeling like surveillance.

PROMPT 077

The Accountability Log

PROMPT

I'm going to work for [time]. Every [X minutes] I'll check in with a one-line update on what I just did. You keep a log and give me a summary at the end. Start the log now.

WHEN TO USE THIS

You want a running record of your work session that you can review - both for accountability and to see that you actually did something on hard days.

WHY IT WORKS

ADHD brains often can't remember what they did even an hour ago. A running log solves this, and the act of logging creates a feedback loop that reinforces continued work.

PROMPT 078

The Commitment Device

PROMPT

I'm committing to finishing [specific task] by [specific time today]. Witness this commitment. At [time], I'll check back in and tell you whether I did it. If I don't check in, assume I didn't and ask me what happened when I do return.

WHEN TO USE THIS

You want to make a commitment feel real by stating it explicitly to someone (or something) that will hold you to it.

WHY IT WORKS

Public commitment activates a different motivational pathway than private intention. Even "public" to an AI creates a mild accountability loop that can tip the balance on tasks you're likely to delay.

PROMPT 079**The Check-In Protocol****PROMPT**

Set up a 3-check-in protocol for today: one at [morning time], one at [midday], one at [afternoon]. At each check-in, ask me: what did I finish since last check-in, what's next, and am I on track for my day goal. Set the format now so we run it the same way each time.

WHEN TO USE THIS

You want structured daily check-ins that help you stay oriented throughout the day.

WHY IT WORKS

Multiple check-ins throughout the day mimic the external structure that ADHD brains thrive in. Each check-in resets the focus compass, which tends to drift without external anchors.

PROMPT 080**The Worst First****PROMPT**

I'm doing a body double session with you. I tend to avoid the worst task on my list. Call it: ask me right now what the thing is that I least want to do. Then help me do that one first before anything else.

WHEN TO USE THIS

You tend to do "productive avoidance" during work sessions - doing real work, but not the most important or hardest thing.

WHY IT WORKS

The "worst first" approach works because ADHD willpower is highest early in a work session. The aversive task has less resistance when you haven't yet spent cognitive resources on easier wins. Starting with the hard thing often makes the rest of the session feel easy.

PROMPT 081**The Witness Protocol****PROMPT**

I need a witness for [difficult task]. I'm going to do it right now and I want you to be here. I'll narrate as I go. Just say "I see you" at the end.

WHEN TO USE THIS

You need emotional presence and witnessing for a task that feels bigger than its practical components.

WHY IT WORKS

Some tasks have accumulated emotional weight that makes them feel much harder than they are technically. Having a witness - even an AI - for the attempt creates a relational context that can reduce shame and increase follow-through.

PROMPT 082**The End-of-Day Review****PROMPT**

Help me close out my work day. Ask me: what did I finish today, what didn't I get to and why, and what's the one thing I need to make sure I don't forget tomorrow. Then tell me I can officially stop working.

WHEN TO USE THIS

You need a formal end-of-day ritual to help your brain actually close and stop working.

WHY IT WORKS

ADHD brains often don't have a natural off switch. A closing ritual - review, capture, and explicit permission to stop - creates psychological closure that helps prevent work from bleeding into personal time and improves next-day startup.

PROMPT 083**The Progress Witness****PROMPT**

I've been working on [long project] for [time]. I'm struggling to feel like I've made progress. Help me document what I've actually done since [start date]. Ask me what I've completed, what I've learned, and what problems I've solved.

WHEN TO USE THIS

A long project doesn't feel like it's moving, and that feeling is draining motivation even though work is happening.

WHY IT WORKS

ADHD brains are poor at tracking accumulated progress. When progress is invisible, motivation erodes. Actively documenting and witnessing progress makes it real and counters the "I never finish anything" narrative.

PROMPT 084**The No-Excuse Check-In****PROMPT**

I told you I'd finish [task] by [time]. Check in with me now. Ask me if I did it. Don't let me explain or minimize if I didn't. Just ask: did you do it, yes or no? Then based on my answer, what happens next?

WHEN TO USE THIS

You need a hard accountability check-in with no wiggle room.

WHY IT WORKS

ADHD self-report tends toward minimizing or explaining away missed commitments. A binary yes/no check-in creates honest accounting. The "what happens next" question pivots immediately to action rather than processing, which is where accountability sessions often lose their effectiveness.

PROMPT 085**The Sprint Partner****PROMPT**

Be my sprint partner for a 25-minute sprint. Call start, check in at the halfway point to ask what I'm on, call end and ask me what I finished. Between those points, you're just present - don't talk unless I address you.

WHEN TO USE THIS

You want time-boxed accountability without constant intervention.

WHY IT WORKS

Timed sprints with minimal interruption give you the benefits of body doubling and time structure without the overhead of constant check-ins. The start and end calls create clear boundaries; the midpoint check maintains light accountability.

PROMPT 086**The Peer Review Request****PROMPT**

I finished [task] but I'm not sure if it's good enough. I'm going to second-guess myself forever if I don't get an outside read. Review [what I just did] and tell me: is this done enough to ship or hand off? Be direct.

WHEN TO USE THIS

You've completed something but can't tell if it's finished because perfectionism is holding you in review mode.

WHY IT WORKS

ADHD perfectionism often manifests as endless revision loops. An external "is this done enough?" verdict creates permission to stop. The specificity of "done enough to ship or hand off" - not "is this perfect" - is the right frame.

PROMPT 087**The Weekend Reset****PROMPT**

It's the end of the week and I feel scattered and behind. Do a weekend reset with me. Ask me: what did I finish this week, what got carried over, and what do I need to set up for Monday. Help me close the week with a sense of order.

WHEN TO USE THIS

You're ending a week feeling like you didn't accomplish enough. You need closure and orientation before the weekend.

WHY IT WORKS

Without a structured week-close, ADHD brains tend to carry the week's unfinished business into the weekend as ambient anxiety. A reset ritual creates a clear boundary and reduces the mental load of unfinished business bleeding into rest time.

PROMPT 088**The Shared Task****PROMPT**

I need to do [task] with someone else involved and I'm dreading the coordination. Help me plan the smallest coordination footprint possible: what I need to communicate, what I need from them, and a template message to send right now.

WHEN TO USE THIS

A task requires coordinating with another person and the coordination overhead feels overwhelming.

WHY IT WORKS

ADHD often makes coordination-heavy tasks feel disproportionately hard. Reducing coordination to its minimum footprint - one message, one ask, one handoff - lowers the executive function load and makes it actually executable.

PROMPT 089**The Accountability Pair Prompt****PROMPT**

I'm going to share this prompt with my accountability partner. Write a 3-question check-in template we can use every week. Questions should cover: what we committed to, what happened, and what we're committing to next. Keep it under 5 minutes to complete.

WHEN TO USE THIS

You want to set up a structured accountability partnership with a real human.

WHY IT WORKS

Human accountability partnerships are highly effective for ADHD when they're structured and consistent. A template removes the overhead of figuring out what to say each time and ensures the check-in actually covers the key points.

PROMPT 090**The Morning Anchor****PROMPT**

Set me up for today. Ask me: what's the one thing I'm committing to finish today? Then write me one sentence I can read when I get distracted or derailed that reminds me what today is about. Keep both parts short.

WHEN TO USE THIS

At the start of the workday, before opening anything else.

WHY IT WORKS

Starting the day with one explicit commitment rather than an overwhelming task list gives the ADHD brain a north star. A single sentence reminder for derailment moments is cognitively cheap to process and effective as a brief reorientation.

SECTION 7

Task Wrap-Up and Transitions

When finishing is harder than starting

PROMPT 091

The Done Check

PROMPT

I think I'm done with [task] but I can't tell if I actually am or if I'm avoiding the last 10%. Ask me 5 questions to help me figure out if this is done or if there's something left I'm avoiding.

WHEN TO USE THIS

You feel like something is finished but you have a nagging feeling it might not be.

WHY IT WORKS

ADHD brains can struggle to know when they're done - sometimes abandoning things early, sometimes over-finishing past the point of returns. A checklist of "done or avoiding?" questions helps distinguish between genuine completion and premature exit.

PROMPT 092

The Ship-It Prompt

PROMPT

I've been working on [thing] for too long and I need to ship it. Talk me out of perfectionism. Remind me what "good enough to ship" means in real terms and help me make the decision to send it now.

WHEN TO USE THIS

You're in a perfectionism loop that's delaying delivery. The work is good enough but you keep finding reasons to refine.

WHY IT WORKS

Perfectionism in ADHD often co-exists with deep fear of judgment. "Good enough to ship" isn't a lowering of standards - it's an honest assessment of when further effort stops adding proportional value. Permission to ship from an external voice can break the loop.

PROMPT 093

The Handoff Checklist

PROMPT

I'm handing off [task/project] to [person or team]. Build me a handoff checklist for this specific task. What do I need to communicate, what should I document, and what would future-me wish past-me had included?

WHEN TO USE THIS

Something is complete and needs to move to someone else. You want to hand it off cleanly without forgetting anything important.

WHY IT WORKS

ADHD brains are notoriously bad at handoffs because the context lives in your head and transferring it requires deliberate effort. A task-specific checklist ensures the invisible knowledge gets documented before it disappears from your working memory.

PROMPT 094**The Transition Script****PROMPT**

I need to move from [work mode] to [personal/rest mode] at [time]. Help me design a 10-minute transition ritual that actually signals to my brain that work is over. Make it physical, sensory, and consistent.

WHEN TO USE THIS

You can't stop working or can't unplug because your brain doesn't have a clear end-of-work signal.

WHY IT WORKS

ADHD brains have difficulty with mode transitions. A physical ritual - consistent movements, environment changes, sensory signals - creates a conditioned response over time. Your brain learns that X means "work is over" the same way it learns that a coffee shop means "time to work."

PROMPT 095**The Closure Ritual****PROMPT**

I finished [project/big task]. I tend to immediately move to the next thing without acknowledging what I just did. Help me mark this moment. Tell me what I finished, why it mattered, and give me a small thing I can do right now to celebrate.

WHEN TO USE THIS

You've just completed something significant. You're about to skip past it without acknowledging it.

WHY IT WORKS

ADHD brains often move immediately to the next thing without processing completions. This erodes the motivational reward that finishing should provide. Brief, genuine acknowledgment of completions builds the feedback loop that makes future tasks feel more rewarding to finish.

PROMPT 096**The Lingering Task Closer****PROMPT**

[Task] has been 90% done for [time]. I can't seem to close it out. Help me figure out what's stopping me from finishing the last 10% - is it perfectionism, fear, or just a task I hate? Then help me finish it in the next 20 minutes.

WHEN TO USE THIS

Something has been "almost done" for too long. The lingering of it is taking up mental space.

WHY IT WORKS

Near-done tasks have a specific psychology in ADHD. Sometimes the last 10% is the hardest part (the scary or boring part). Sometimes perfectionists avoid finishing because finishing means being judged. Diagnosing which is happening changes the fix.

PROMPT 097**The Transition Buffer****PROMPT**

I'm switching from [high-intensity task] to [low-intensity task] and I know the switch will be rough. Design me a 5-minute buffer between them that helps my brain downshift without falling into distraction.

WHEN TO USE THIS

You're moving between very different types of work and you want to manage the transition so you don't crash.

WHY IT WORKS

Moving from high-intensity to low-intensity work without a buffer often leads to ADHD overcorrection - your brain goes from intense focus to completely offline. A brief intentional buffer allows gradual downshift rather than a jarring cut.

PROMPT 098**The Leftovers List****PROMPT**

I'm wrapping up my work session. Before I close everything, ask me: what are the open loops? What was I in the middle of that I need to pick back up? Help me make a specific re-entry note for each one so tomorrow-me knows exactly where I left off.

WHEN TO USE THIS

At the end of a work session, before closing files and applications.

WHY IT WORKS

ADHD brains are poor at re-entry context without notes. Writing re-entry notes at session close is far more effective than trying to reconstruct context at session open. The investment of 3 minutes at close saves 20 minutes of re-entry confusion the next day.

PROMPT 099**The Meeting Debrief****PROMPT**

I just finished a meeting about [topic]. I need to capture action items before I lose them. Ask me: what decisions were made, what do I personally need to do, and by when. Give me a formatted follow-up note I can send within the hour.

WHEN TO USE THIS

Immediately after a meeting, while the content is still fresh.

WHY IT WORKS

ADHD working memory fades fast. Action items from meetings disappear within minutes without capture. The combination of immediate debrief and a formatted follow-up note closes the loop before memory fails.

PROMPT 100**The Weekend-to-Week Bridge****PROMPT**

It's Sunday evening (or Monday morning) and I need to bridge from weekend mode to work mode. Help me do this: review what's coming this week, identify the most important thing for Monday, and set up my workspace for a clean start. 10 minutes total.

WHEN TO USE THIS

At the transition from rest to work week. You want a structured bridge rather than a jarring re-entry.

WHY IT WORKS

Weekend-to-weekday transitions are often where ADHD momentum breaks. A structured bridge session reduces the activation cost of Monday morning and sets context that makes the first hour of the week more productive.

PROMPT 101**The Graceful Exit****PROMPT**

I have to leave [task/project] before it's done - permanently or for now. Help me document where I am in a way that either I or someone else could pick it up cleanly. Ask me what I'd need to know to re-enter this from scratch.

WHEN TO USE THIS

You're leaving something unfinished and you want to hand off or close it with dignity.

WHY IT WORKS

Abandoned or paused projects are painful for ADHD brains partly because the undocumented loose ends create ambient anxiety. Closing a task with explicit documentation - even if unfinished - is better than leaving it as an open loop in your mental workspace.

PROMPT 102**The Completion Summary****PROMPT**

I just finished [significant task/project]. Write a 3-sentence completion summary for my records. Cover: what was delivered, what I learned, and what I'd do differently. Keep it factual. This is for future-me, not for show.

WHEN TO USE THIS

After completing something meaningful. You want to build institutional knowledge about your own work patterns.

WHY IT WORKS

ADHD often means starting things with high enthusiasm and forgetting what you learned by the time the next similar task comes around. Brief completion summaries build a personal knowledge base that reduces repeat mistakes.

PROMPT 103**The Good Enough Marker****PROMPT**

Help me define what "good enough" means for [task]. Not "good enough for me" but "good enough for the actual purpose this serves." Set the bar explicitly so I know when to stop.

WHEN TO USE THIS

You're working on something and don't know when to stop. The absence of a clear bar is keeping you in infinite-refinement mode.

WHY IT WORKS

ADHD perfectionism often thrives in the absence of explicit success criteria. Setting a specific, purpose-based "good enough" bar makes stopping a logical conclusion rather than a surrender.

PROMPT 104**The Day-End Permission****PROMPT**

It's [time] and I said I'd stop at [earlier time]. Tell me I can stop now without guilt. Remind me what I did today that counts. And tell me what the right thing to do with the rest of tonight is, given what I have tomorrow.

WHEN TO USE THIS

You're still working past your intended stop time and you need external permission to stop.

WHY IT WORKS

ADHD brains often need explicit external permission to disengage. Self-permission is unreliable when you feel you haven't done "enough." An honest external accounting of what was done, plus permission to stop, is sometimes the only thing that actually works.

PROMPT 105**The Season Closer****PROMPT**

I'm closing out [month/quarter/year]. Before I look forward, help me look back without judgment. Ask me: what am I genuinely proud of, what do I want to let go of, and what am I carrying forward. Three answers. That's it.

WHEN TO USE THIS

At a meaningful natural close - end of month, end of year, or any significant transition point.

WHY IT WORKS

ADHD time experience is often non-linear - the past doesn't feel like it existed and the future doesn't feel like it will. Creating deliberate close-and-look-back rituals at natural transitions builds continuity and counters the feeling that time just disappears.

You Made It

That's 105 prompts. You don't need to use them in order. You don't need to use all of them. Find the section that matches where you are right now and try one.

These prompts work best when you use them as starting points, not scripts. Adapt them to your actual situation. The more specific you are about what you're dealing with, the more useful the AI's response will be.

More from Vynlith

The ADHD Daily Planner and Body Doubling Tracker pair well with this pack for building daily structure. Both available at vynlith.gumroad.com.

If this pack helped you

Leave a review on Gumroad - it helps other ADHD people find this pack. We built it because we couldn't find anything that actually spoke to how ADHD works. If it resonated, let others know.

vynlith.gumroad.com

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